KAGZI · ENGLISH MEDIUM

Weekly Current Affairs · 1–6 November 2026

UPSC · UPPSC · UPSSSC · SSC

PART 02 · WEEKLY REVISION

Weekly Current Affairs Summary · 1–6 November 2026

This is an interim weekly summary for a week that is still in progress; it is not a complete weekly report.

Major themes of the week

- **Energy transition:** Grid-scale energy storage and support for reliable renewable power.
- **Digital technology and AI:** IndiaAI Mission and indigenous foundation models.
- **Economy and transport:** Railway freight loading and logistics indicators.
- **Statistics and governance:** VISTAR and data-driven governance.
- **Clean energy:** Developments related to Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo 2026.
- **Parliamentary accountability:** Public Accounts Committees and audit of public expenditure.
- **Uttar Pradesh:** Kashi Tamil Sangamam 5.0 and the State’s share in tax devolution.
- **Science and environment:** Gaia-based stellar research, watershed management and biodiversity conservation.

How to revise weekly

Classify news under national, international, economy, science and technology, environment, sports, awards and Uttar Pradesh. At the end of the week, revise 3–5 facts from each category and attempt 10–15 multiple-choice questions. Verify schemes and figures against the original government release.

Source directory: **Press Information Bureau (PIB)** · **UPSC** · **United Nations**

DATE-WISE NEWS DIGEST

Detailed Daily News Digest

The dated daily stories currently available are consolidated below for weekly revision. Each story retains its context, exam relevance and official source reference.

6 November 2026 — Daily Current Affairs

National · Examinations & Administration

UPSC Civil Services Main Examination 2026 written result declared

The Union Public Service Commission declared the written result of the Civil Services (Main) Examination 2026 on 5 November 2026. The official list identifies **2,526 candidates** as qualified for the Personality Test (Interview). The Main Examination was held from 21 to 30 August 2026.

Next steps: The online DAF-II window is scheduled from 11 November to 25 November 2026, up to 6:00 PM. Interview dates will be announced separately. Verification of eligibility documents remains applicable.

Exam relevance: UPSC selection process, Personality Test, DAF-II and official commission notifications.

Official sources: **UPSC — Civil Services (Main) Examination 2026** · **Official qualified candidates list (PDF)**

National · Urban Transport

India’s metro network reaches approximately 1,200 km

A PIB release dated 5 November stated that India’s metro network has expanded from 248 km across five cities in 2014 to approximately **1,200 km across 26 cities**. More than one crore passengers use metro services every day, according to the release.

Context: Metro rail is a high-capacity urban public transport system. Network expansion is linked to urbanisation, traffic management and public transport infrastructure.

Exam relevance: Urban development, transport infrastructure and sustainable cities.

Official source: **PIB — Metro network expansion, 5 Nov 2026**

Economy · Fiscal Federalism

₹1,09,019 crore released to States as advance tax devolution

The Union Government released a regular tax devolution instalment of **₹1,09,019 crore** to States on 5 November 2026. The instalment was normally due on 10 November but was released early to support States' capital and welfare expenditure ahead of upcoming festivals.

Uttar Pradesh focus: The State-wise table in the PIB release lists **₹19,208 crore** for Uttar Pradesh.

Exam relevance: Tax devolution, Centre–State financial relations and fiscal federalism. Tax devolution is a transfer of the Union's shareable tax revenue to States.

Official source: **PIB — Tax devolution to States, 5 Nov 2026**

Rural Development · Livelihood

Joint advisory on fodder and livestock infrastructure under VB–G RAM G

The Department of Rural Development and the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying issued joint advice to States and Union Territories on strengthening fodder security, pasture development and livestock-supporting infrastructure. PIB states that the VB–G RAM G Act, 2025 provides a statutory guarantee of **125 days of wage employment** for each rural household and came into force on 1 July 2026.

Key facts: The advisory identifies 22 permissible works related to fodder production and storage, pastures, animal shelters, dairy facilities and veterinary services.

Exam relevance: Rural employment, livestock economy, Gram Panchayat planning and livelihood assets.

Official source: **PIB — Fodder and livestock infrastructure advisory, 5 Nov 2026**

Economy · Tribal Livelihoods

MSME–TRIFED agreement to support PM Vishwakarma artisans

The Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises and TRIFED signed an agreement to improve market access for eligible tribal artisans. Cooperation includes product display and promotion through Tribes India retail outlets and its online marketplace, capacity building and market linkages. A “Tribes India–PM Vishwakarma Collection” is also proposed.

Exam relevance: Traditional crafts, micro-enterprises, tribal livelihoods and market access.

Official source: **PIB — MSME–TRIFED MoU, 5 Nov 2026**

Science & Technology · Astronomy

UBC 63 identified as a system of two distinct stellar clusters

A team led by Indian astronomers identified UBC 63 not as a single open star cluster but as a system comprising **UBC 63A and UBC 63B**. The system is reported to be about 4,892 light-years from Earth. The analysis used stellar position and motion data from the European Space Agency’s Gaia mission.

Why it matters: Studying the structure and motion of two stellar clusters after a close encounter can improve understanding of the evolution of star clusters in the Milky Way.

Exam relevance: Open star clusters, the Milky Way, gravity and the Gaia mission.

Official source: **PIB — UBC 63 double-cluster finding, 5 Nov 2026**

Environment · Water Resource Management

National consultation on draft technical guidelines for watershed management

The Department of Land Resources, National Rainfed Area Authority and ICAR–NBSS&LUP held a two-day national consultation on draft technical guidelines for improved watershed management on 4–5 November. The discussion took place under the World Bank-assisted REWARD programme.

Key ideas: Scientific evidence, technology, cost-effectiveness, flexibility for local conditions and community participation. The guidelines were described as being at the draft/consultation stage, not as a final notification.

Exam relevance: Rainfed agriculture, soil and water conservation, watershed areas and participatory rural development.

Official source: **PIB — Watershed management consultation, 5 Nov 2026**

Awards · Science & Technology

CSIR–NEERI wins first prize at National AI-ML Hackathon 2026

CSIR–National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR–NEERI), Nagpur, received first prize for Problem Statement 2 at the R&D-2026 national hackathon. Its proposed model uses AI/ML and GIS to count trees, identify species and estimate tree height. PIB reported that the hackathon received 70 proposals.

Exam relevance: Environmental monitoring, GIS, artificial intelligence and applied scientific research.

Official source: **PIB — CSIR–NEERI award, 5 Nov 2026**

Sports · Para Sports

Indian contingent records 114 medals at Asian Para Games 2026

A PIB account released on 5 November recorded **114 medals** for the Indian contingent: 30 gold, 35 silver and 49 bronze. It also mentioned five world records and nine Asian records. Of the 56 women athletes, 34 won medals.

Exam relevance: Para sports, inclusive sports infrastructure and medal classifications.

Official source: PIB — Indian contingent at Asian Para Games 2026, 5 Nov 2026.

Important Day · International

5 November — World Tsunami Awareness Day

The United Nations General Assembly designated 5 November as World Tsunami Awareness Day in December 2015. The 2026 UN theme is **“Be Tsunami Ready: Resilience starts with you.”** It focuses on community preparedness, timely warnings, risk education and disaster risk reduction.

Exam relevance: Disaster management, early warning systems, the Sendai Framework and UN observances.

Official sources: **UN Web TV — World Tsunami Awareness Day 2026** · **United Nations — Background**

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Uttar Pradesh · Education & Culture

Preparations reviewed for Kashi Tamil Sangamam 5.0 in Varanasi

A high-level meeting was held at Banaras Hindu University (BHU), Varanasi, on 3 November to review preparations for the fifth Kashi Tamil Sangamam. The programme is proposed from **28 November to 12 December 2026**. Its theme is “Thirukkural Payilvom – Let us learn the Thirukkural”. Varanasi, Prayagraj and Ayodhya are included in the programme. The initiative aims to strengthen educational, cultural and linguistic exchanges between Tamil Nadu and Kashi/Uttar Pradesh.

Exam relevance: Uttar Pradesh, culture, education and national integration.

Official source: PIB — Ministry of Education, 4 Nov 2026.

Environment · Biodiversity

2026 guidelines issued for India’s I-OECMs

India’s Environment Ministry issued national guidelines during CBD COP-17 to identify and report Other Effective Area-Based Conservation Measures (OECMs). These may be areas that are not legally notified protected areas but make an effective contribution to long-term biodiversity conservation. Examples include community-managed water bodies, sacred groves, biodiversity parks and some coastal or marine areas. I-OECM recognition does not automatically turn an area into a legally protected area or change its ownership.

Exam relevance: Biodiversity, in-situ conservation, the Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework and the 30x30 target.

Official source: PIB — MoEFCC, 4 Nov 2026.

International Relations · Defence

First India–Canada Defence Dialogue held

The first defence dialogue between India and Canada was held virtually on 3 November 2026. Discussions covered defence policy, strategic perspectives, defence industry, military-technical cooperation and defence research and development. The PIB release describes a dialogue on potential areas of cooperation; it should not be reported as a signed defence agreement or a joint military exercise.

Exam relevance: India’s bilateral relations, defence diplomacy and the Indo-Pacific context.

Official source: PIB — Ministry of Defence, 4 Nov 2026.

Economy · Critical Minerals

₹2,814 crore approved for lithium and nickel processing

The Union Cabinet approved a Capex Support Scheme with an outlay of **₹2,814 crore** to promote processing of critical minerals, including lithium and nickel. Critical minerals are important to the supply chains for the energy transition, batteries, electronics and advanced manufacturing.

Exam relevance: Mineral resources, energy security, battery value chains and import dependence. Consult the original Cabinet release for eligibility and benefit conditions.

Official source: PIB — Cabinet releases, 4 Nov 2026.

Parliamentary System · Accountability

Digital audit monitoring platform discussed for Public Accounts Committees

Releases from the Lok Sabha Secretariat on 4 November highlighted the need for a shared Digital Audit Monitoring Platform for State Legislatures, modelled on parliamentary systems. The Public Accounts Committee (PAC) plays an important role in legislative scrutiny of government expenditure and appropriation accounts.

Exam relevance: Parliamentary committees, financial accountability, CAG reports and legislative oversight.

Official source: PIB — Lok Sabha Secretariat releases, 4 Nov 2026.

4 November 2026 — Daily Current Affairs

Energy & Economy

₹14,500 crore VGF scheme for grid-scale energy storage

The Union Cabinet approved a Viability Gap Funding (VGF) scheme with an outlay of **₹14,500 crore** to support the development of 92 GWh of grid-scale energy storage systems. Large-scale storage can help integrate renewable energy and improve electricity grid management. VGF is financial support intended to make socially or economically useful but financially challenging projects viable.

Exam relevance: Energy storage, solar and wind integration, grid stability and public financial support.

Official source: PIB — Cabinet releases, 4 Nov 2026.

Governance & Statistics

VISTAR scheme approved for 2026–27 to 2030–31

VISTAR stands for **Viksit Bharat Initiative for Statistical Transformation, Analytics & Research**. It was approved as a Central Sector Scheme for 2026–27 to 2030–31. Its focus is strengthening government statistics, analytics and research systems.

Exam relevance: Quality and timeliness of official statistics, evidence-based policymaking and institutional statistical capacity.

Official source: PIB — Cabinet releases.

Transport · Railways

Indian Railways records 145.07 million tonnes of freight in October 2026

According to a Ministry of Railways PIB release, Indian Railways recorded **145.07 million tonnes** of freight loading in October 2026. Freight data are useful indicators of transport, industrial activity and logistics performance.

Exam relevance: Distinguish freight loading from passenger transport and remember the reporting period and unit.

Official source: PIB — Railway releases, October 2026.

Science & Technology · Artificial Intelligence

Indigenous foundation models under the IndiaAI Mission

PIB reported the release of EKA-1 and the Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B models under the IndiaAI Mission. A foundation model is a large-scale AI model trained on broad datasets and designed to serve as a base for multiple applications.

Exam relevance: Artificial intelligence, domestic technology capacity, language and data resources, and responsible AI.

Official source: PIB — IndiaAI Mission release listing.

Detailed news stories included: 19. Count reflects the available daily source material.

Weekly Practice Questions

6 November 2026 — Daily Current Affairs

Daily MCQ — 6 November 2026

1. How many candidates qualified for the UPSC CSE Main 2026 Personality Test? **2,526.**
2. What was the reported length of India's metro network? **About 1,200 km across 26 cities.**
3. How much tax devolution was listed for Uttar Pradesh? **₹19,208 crore.**
4. Which two clusters make up UBC 63? **UBC 63A and UBC 63B.**
5. When is World Tsunami Awareness Day observed? **5 November.**
6. What was India's Asian Para Games medal tally cited in the release? **114: 30 gold, 35 silver and 49 bronze.**
7. How many days of wage employment are cited under the VB–G RAM G Act, 2025? **125 days.**

5 November 2026 — Daily Current Affairs

Daily Practice Questions — 5 November 2026

1. When is Kashi Tamil Sangamam 5.0 proposed? **28 November–12 December 2026.**
2. What does I-OECM recognition automatically do to land ownership or legal protected-area status? **Neither: it does not automatically change ownership or confer legal protected-area status.**
3. When was the first India–Canada Defence Dialogue held? **Virtually on 3 November 2026.**
4. What is the approved outlay for the critical-mineral processing Capex Support Scheme? **₹2,814 crore.**
5. What does the Public Accounts Committee scrutinise? **Government expenditure and appropriation accounts.**

4 November 2026 — Daily Current Affairs

Daily Practice Questions — 4 November 2026

1. What is the outlay of the grid-scale energy storage VGF scheme? **₹14,500 crore.**

2. What does VISTAR stand for? **Viksit Bharat Initiative for Statistical Transformation, Analytics & Research.**
3. How much freight did Indian Railways load in October 2026, according to the source? **145.07 million tonnes.**
4. Which mission was associated with the release of EKA-1 and Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B? **IndiaAI Mission.**